Curriculum Vitae

Mei Dong

CONTACT INFORMATION
Toronto, ON, Canada
Personal Website
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Google Scholar

RESEARCH INTEREST
Causal Inference, Statistical Genetics, Semiparametric Inference, LLM Evaluation

EDUCATION

University of Toronto

Ph.D., Biostatistics, 2021 - Present

Advisors: Wei Xu, Ph.D., Linbo Wang, Ph.D.

University of Saskatchewan

M.S., Statistics, Sept 2017 - Jun 2019

Advisors: Longhai Li, Ph.D., Lloyd Balbuena, Ph.D.

Donghua University

B.S., Statistics, Sept 2013 - Jun 2017

Advisor: Xin Liu, Ph.D.

FELLOWSHIPS & GRANTS

NSERC Postdoctoral Fellowship (140K CAD) 2027.1-2028.12

DSI Doctoral Student Fellowship (75K CAD) 2024-2027

Queen Elizabeth II/Sanofi/John G. FitzGerald Graduate Scholarships in Science and Technology (30K CAD) 2023-2024, 2025-2026

University of Toronto Fellowships (50K CAD) 2021-2023

Graduate Teaching Fellowship, University of Saskatchewan (38K CAD) 2017 - 2019

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Student Research Associate

Dalla Lana School of Public Health, University of Toronto Jul 2022 - Dec 2025

Research Data Analyst

Dalla Lana School of Public Health, University of Toronto May 2019 - Jun 2021

Research Assistant

University of Saskatchewan Sept 2018 - May 2019

Teaching Experience

Co-Instructor Jul 2026

Foundations and Trends in Causal Inference, co-taught with Linbo Wang
Biostatistics Summer School, Peking University, Beijing, China

Co-Instructor Apr 2023 & Jun 2022

Handling Missing Data in Health Science Research, co-taught with Aya Mitani
Data Science Interdisciplinary Research Cluster, Dalla Lana School of Public Health

Teaching Assistant Sept 2021 - Present

University of Toronto

Teaching Assistant Sept 2017 - May 2019

University of Saskatchewan

Working Papers

1. **Dong M**, Yan J, Liu L, Wang L. Efficient adjustment sets for inverse probability weighted estimation in causal graphical models.
2. Haycock P, **Dong M**, Liu Y, Vanderwerff B, Bate T, et al. A meta-analysis of genome-wide association studies of lung cancer survival.
3. Bate T, **Dong M**, Ogamba C, Liu Y, Seviiri M, et al. Investigating the repurposing potential of cardiometabolic and hormonal medications for cancer treatment using Mendelian randomisation.

Preprint

1. **Dong M**, Zhao R, Zhang Y, Wu X, Wang L. From Benchmark to Deployment: Efficient Evaluation of LLMs for Health under Task and Evaluator Shift. (submitted)
2. **Dong M**, Liu L, Tang D, Liu G, Xu W, Wang L. Average treatment effect Estimation with non-binary instrumental variables. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2510.14368v2* (Under review)

   IMS Hannan Graduate Student Travel Award

   SSC General Student Research Oral Presentation Award

   U of T Department of Statistics Research Day, Best Poster Award
3. Hou T, Thakral A, Hueniken K, ..., **Dong M**, Xu W, Lee J, Liu G. Genetic liability to smoking and alcohol use and risk and survival in head and neck squamous cell carcinoma: Towards a personalized approach. (submitted)
4. Bate T, **Dong M**, Liu Y, Seviiri M, Brown MC, et al. Investigating the repurposing potential of immune checkpoint inhibition for cancer treatment using Mendelian randomisation. (Under revision)

Publications (* Co-first authorship)

1. **Dong M**, Wang L, Liu L, Dukes O. Mei Dong, Linbo Wang, Lin Liu, and Oliver Dukes's contribution to the Discussion of "Regression by composition" by Farewell et al. Journal of the Royal Statistical Society Series B: Statistical Methodology. 2026; qkag093.
2. Hou T, Thakral A, ..., **Dong M**, ..., Liu G. Polygenic risk score-based smoking and drinking behaviors and head and neck squamous cell cancer risk by HPV status. Cancer Research. [Abstract Publication]. 2025; 85(8_Supplement_1):7399.

3. **Dong M**, Thakral A, Byrne KS, Bosse Y, Zhou H, et al. Genome-wide association study of early-Stage non-small cell lung cancer prognosis: A pooled analysis in the International Lung Cancer Consortium. Carcinogenesis. 2025;46(2):bgaf031.

4. Lam A, Hueniken K, Pienkowski M, Lee J W, **Dong M**, et al. Performance of eight smoking metrics for modeling survival in head and neck squamous cell carcinoma. JAMA Otolaryngology–Head & Neck Surgery. 2025; 151(4):360-70.

5. Xue M, Leibovitzh H, Shao J, Neustaeter A, **Dong M**, et al. Environmental factors associated with risk of Crohn's disease development in the CCC-GEM Project: A prospective cohort of healthy first-Degree relatives of CD patients. Clinical Gastroenterology and Hepatology. 2024;22(9):1889-97.

6. **Dong M**, Mitani A. Multiple imputation methods for missing multilevel ordinal outcomes. BMC Medical Research Methodology. 2023;23:112.

7. Xue M, Turpin W, Haim L, Lee SH, Neustaeter A, **Dong M**, et al. A198 The long-term impact of environment exposures on host health and the risk factors of Crohn's disease. Journal of the Canadian Association of Gastroenterology. [Abstract Publication]. 2023;6(Suppl 1):41.

8. García-Pardo M, Chang A, Schmid S, **Dong M**, Brown MC, et al. Respiratory and cardiometabolic comorbidities and Stage I-III non-small cell lung cancer (NSCLC) survival: A pooled analysis from the International Lung Cancer Consortium (ILCCO). Journal of Thoracic Oncology. 2023;18(3):313-23.

9. Fuoco J, **Dong M**, MacMillan C, Kak I, Perez-Ordonez B, Bradley G, Xu W, Magalhaes M. A 10-Year review of intraoral salivary gland tumor diagnoses: diagnostic challenges and inter-observer agreement. Head and Neck Pathology. 2023;17(1):193-203.

10. García-Pardo M, Chang A, Schmid S, **Dong M**, Brown MC, et al. Respiratory and cardiometabolic comorbidities and stage I-III non-small cell lung cancer (NSCLC) survival: A pooled analysis from the International Lung Cancer Consortium (ILCCO). Annals of Oncology. [Abstract Publication]. 2022;33:S979.

11. Turpin W*, **Dong M***, Sasson G*, Garay JA*, Espin-Garcia O, et al. Mediterranean-like dietary pattern associations with gut microbiome composition and subclinical gastrointestinal inflammation. Gastroenterology. 2022;163(3):685-98.

12. Schmid S, Jiang M, Brown MC, Fares A, Garcia M, Soriano J, **Dong M**, Thomas S, et al. Accounting for EGFR mutations in epidemiologic analyses of non–small cell lung cancers: examples based on the international lung cancer consortium data. Cancer Epidemiology, Biomarkers & Prevention. 2022;31(3):679-87.

13. Bai W*, **Dong M***, Li L, Feng C, Xu W. Randomized quantile residuals for diagnosing zero-inflated generalized linear mixed models with applications to microbiome count data. BMC bioinformatics. 2021;22:564.

14. Shestopaloff K*, **Dong M***, Gao F, Xu W. DCMD: Distance-based classification using mixture distributions on microbiome data. PLoS computational biology. 2021;17(3): e1008799.

15. **Dong M***, Li L*, Chen M, Kusalik A, Xu W. Predictive analysis methods for human microbiome data with application to Parkinson's disease. PLoS One. 2020;15(8): e0237779.

Invited Talks

1. The 7th ICSA-Canada Chapter Symposium — Aug 2026
   McGill University, Montreal, QC, Canada
2. The 8th Pacific Causal Inference Conference — Jul 2026
   Tianjin, China
3. The 39th New England Statistics Symposium — May 2026
   Storrs, CT, USA

Presentations

1. European Causal Inference Meeting — April 2026
   Oxford, UK
2. Brown Bag Seminar, University of Toronto — April 2026
   Toronto, CA
3. Center for Causal Inference Seminar, University of Pennsylvania — Feb 2026
   Virtual
4. 2025 ICSA International Conference [poster] — Dec 2025
   Taipei, Taiwan
5. DSI causal inference workshop [poster] — Oct 2025
   Toronto, Canada
6. 2025 Joint Statistical Meetings — Aug 2025
   Nashville, USA
7. The Statistical Society of Canada 2025 Annual Meeting — May 2025
   Saskatoon, Canada
8. Research Day, Department of Statistics, University of Toronto [poster] — Apr 2025
   Toronto, Canada
9. The 2025 ENAR Spring Meeting — Mar 2025
   New Orleans, USA
10. The Statistical Society of Canada 2024 Annual Meeting — Jun 2024
    St. John's, Canada
11. 2023 Joint Statistical Meetings — Aug 2023
    Toronto, Canada
12. The Statistical Society of Canada 2022 Annual Meeting — May 2022
    Virtual
13. Research Day, Division of Biostatistics, University of Toronto [poster] — May 2022
    Virtual
14. The Statistical Society of Canada 2019 Annual Meeting — May 2019
    Calgary, Canada

SERVICE

Conference Photograph Volunteer May 2025
The 13th Annual Canadian Statistics Student Conference

Conference Organizing Committee Sept 2024 - May 2025
Fundraising Committee of The 13th Annual Canadian Statistics Student Conference (CSSC)

Reviewer
JRSSA
Biometrics
Canadian Journal of Statistics
Sociological Methods & Research
University of Toronto Journal of Public Health (UTJPH)

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

INI causal inference Workshop on Causal inference in Biomedicine April 2026
University of Cambridge

INI causal inference Workshop on Causal identification and discovery Mar 2026
University of Cambridge

Sanya Workshop on Causality and Machine Learning Jan 2026
Yau Mathematical Sciences Center, Tsinghua University

AARMS Summer School: *Statistical Learning for High Dimensional Data, Machine Learning and Data Mining* Jun 2018
University of Prince Edward Island

HONORS & AWARDS

ICSA-Canada Chapter 2026 Symposium Student/Postdoc Travel Scholarship 2026

IMS Hannan Graduate Student Travel Award 2026

2025 Joint Statistical Meetings Early Career Travel Award Jun 2025

SSC General Student Research Oral Presentation Award May 2025

Best Poster Award, U of T Department of Statistics Research Day Apr 2025

Winner of 2024 SSC Case Study *(Winner out of 18 teams; joint work with Linke Li, Ziqian Zhuang, Jasper Zhang)* Jun 2024

CANSSI Stage Trainee 2024-2026

U of T SGS travel grant May 2024

Statistical Society of Canada Annual Meeting Student Travel Grant May 2019

University of Saskatchewan Student Travel Award May 2019

Donghua University Outstanding Graduate *(Top 5%)* Jun 2017

Donghua University 1st Class of Tianji Academic Excellence Scholarship 2014 - 2016

Outstanding Student Scholarship of Donghua University *(Top 5%)* 2015 - 2016

Donghua University Outstanding Student Leader Sept 2014